

FAMILY HISTORY RESEARCH STARTER KIT

Printable Genealogy Worksheets

Organize ancestors, sources, cemetery visits, interviews, DNA notes, timelines, and biography drafts.

Designed for handwriting: aligned lines, room to write, and printer-friendly pages.

Schenklemeier&Sons

Start Here

Use one research question at a time. Keep sources, notes, and questions together.

1. Pick one ancestor or one research question.
2. Fill in what you already know.
3. Track every source you check, even if it does not answer the question.
4. Turn evidence into timelines and biography notes.
5. Keep unresolved questions visible for the next research session.

Current research goal / notes

Ancestor Profile

Core identity facts and family relationships. Lines align at the same right margin for a cleaner handwriting layout.

Full name

Known aliases

Birth date/place

Marriage(s)

Death date/place

Burial/cemetery

Father

Mother

Spouse(s)

Children

Residences

Occupation(s)

Military/church

Notes

Vital Events + Relationships

Use this page when one ancestor has multiple marriages, moves, name variants, or conflicting evidence.

Birth		Father	
Baptism		Mother	
Marriage 1		Spouse	
Marriage 2		Child 1	
Divorce		Child 2	
Death		Child 3	
Burial		Sibling(s)	
Residence 1		Witnesses	
Residence 2		Associates	

Research Question Planner

Turn a vague search into a specific question and next steps.

Research question

Known facts

Working theory

Records to search

Places to search

People involved

Date range

Priority

Next action

Result

Research Log

Record every search so you do not repeat work later.

Date	Repository / site	Search terms	Result	Next step

Source Tracker

Capture citation details and what each source actually proves.

Source	Repository / URL	Person/event	Evidence found	Reliability / notes

Timeline Builder

Put events in order. Timelines reveal gaps, conflicts, and next searches.

[illegible]

Census Extraction Worksheet

Extract more than names: neighbors, occupations, ages, property, and nearby relatives matter.

[illegible]

Cemetery Visit Log

Use before and after a cemetery trip. Leave room for nearby graves and follow-up.

Cemetery name

Address / GPS

Ancestor / grave

Section / row

Inscription

Nearby graves

Photos taken

Condition

Follow-up

Notes

Obituary Extraction Worksheet

Obituaries can identify relatives, residences, churches, funeral homes, and burial places.

Name

Death date/place

Survivors

Predeceased

Funeral home

Burial place

Church/groups

Residence clues

New leads

Questions

Family Interview Guide

Use open-ended questions. Leave space for stories, not just facts.

Questions to ask

- What stories did you hear about this person?
- Where did the family live?
- What work did they do?
- Who had photos, letters, or records?
- What family stories are uncertain or disputed?

Interview notes

DNA Match Notes

Record match clues without losing track of uncertainty.

Match	cM	Shared matches	Probable line	Evidence / next step

Evidence Conflict Resolver

Use this when sources disagree.

Conflict / question	
Source A says	
Source B says	
Source C says	
Most reliable source	
Reasoning	
Next record needed	
Current conclusion	
Confidence	
Notes	

Ancestor Biography Outline

Turn research into a readable family story.

Opening scene

Birth/family context

Places lived

Work/community

Marriage/family

Hardships/moves

Historical context

Personality clues

Sources to cite

Unanswered questions

Next Research Session

Close each session by writing the next concrete step.

Top priority	
Record to request	
Website/repository	
Person to contact	
Place to visit	
Document to review	
Question to answer	
Deadline/reminder	
Notes	